

RICCARDO DI FRANCESCO

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(This version: *June 2026*)

Fields: Econometrics; Causal Machine Learning; Applied Microeconometrics; Health/Labour Economics

Job Market Paper: Validating Machine Learning Predictions of Heterogeneous Treatment Effects (joint with [Michael C. Knaus](#))

CURRENT POSITION

Postdoctoral Researcher

Oct. 2024–Present

Beyond the Paycheck (Carlsberg Foundation, CF23-0987)

University of Southern Denmark, Odense

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics and Finance

Sept. 2024

Advisor: *Franco Peracchi*

Co-advisor: *Tommaso Proietti*

Thesis: *“Three Essays in Causal Inference and Machine Learning”*

University of Rome Tor Vergata, Rome

Master of Science in Economics

July 2020

Advisor: *Alberto Iozzi*

Thesis: *“Fleet Competition with Autonomous Vehicles: the Role of Ownership”*

Final Grade: 110/110 *summa cum laude*

University of Rome Tor Vergata, Rome

Bachelor of Science in Political Economics

Oct. 2018

Advisor: *Francesco Nucci*

Thesis: *“Macroeconomic Impacts of Brexit”*

Final Grade: 107/110

University of Rome La Sapienza, Rome

RESEARCH

Publications

- Di Francesco, R. (2026). [Aggregation Trees](#). *Econometric Reviews*, 45(5), 634–659.
- Di Francesco, R., & Mellace, G. (2025). [Causal inference for qualitative outcomes](#). *Economics Letters*, 112626.
- Di Francesco, R. (2025). [Ordered Correlation Forest](#). *Econometric Reviews*, 44(4), 416–432.

Working Papers

- [Behavioral Consequences of Sexual Orientation Disclosure in a Large-Scale Digital Environment](#) (joint with [Enzo Brox](#)). *arXiv preprint arXiv:2403.03649*.

Work in Progress

- A Local Differencing Test for the Credibility of Selection-on-Observables (joint with [Franco Peracchi](#)).

Software

- causalQual: Causal Inference for Qualitative Outcomes. ([Website](#) | [CRAN](#))
- valiCATE: Validation of CATE models. ([Website](#))
- ocf: Ordered Correlation Forest. ([Website](#) | [CRAN](#))
- aggTrees: Aggregation Trees. ([Website](#) | [CRAN](#))

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

Emerging Econometrician Award <i>Econometric Reviews</i> —Winner for the paper <i>Ordered Correlation Forest</i> .	<i>Oct. 2025</i>
Student Best Paper Award <i>IAAE 2024 Thessaloniki</i> —Honorable mention for the paper <i>Ordered Correlation Forest</i> .	<i>June 2024</i>
Ph.D. Scholarship <i>University of Rome Tor Vergata</i> —Scholarship fully financing Ph.D. studies.	<i>Oct. 2020</i>

RESEARCH VISITS

VinUniversity, Hanoi Research visit to NLP Research Group Host: <i>Mo El-Haj</i>	<i>Nov. 2025</i>
Swiss Institute for Empirical Economic Research, St. Gallen Visiting Ph.D. Student Host: <i>Michael Lechner</i>	<i>Feb.–Dec. 2022</i>

TEACHING ACTIVITIES

Guest Lecturer in Health Econometrics Master of Science course University of Southern Denmark, Odense	<i>Mar.–May 2027 (scheduled)</i>
Guest Lecturer in Population Economics Master of Science course University of Southern Denmark, Odense	<i>Sept.–Dec. 2026 (scheduled)</i>
Guest Lecturer in Microeconometrics Master of Science course University of Southern Denmark, Odense	<i>Oct.–Dec. 2025</i>
Teaching Assistant in Statistics Bachelor of Science course LUISS University, Rome	<i>Feb.–May 2024</i>
Teaching Assistant in Applied Statistics and Econometrics Bachelor of Science course LUISS University, Rome	<i>Oct.–Dec. 2023</i>
Teaching Assistant in Statistical Learning Master of Science course University of Rome Tor Vergata, Rome	<i>Sept.–Oct. 2021</i>

SUPERVISION

2 Bachelor theses, 2 Research Assistants (University of Southern Denmark).

REFeree ACTIVITIES

LABOUR, Social Indicators Research.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Conference Reviewer 2026 Annual Meeting of the European Association of Young Economists (EAYE) University of the Basque Country, Bilbao	<i>Jan. 2026</i>
Conference Reviewer 2025 Annual Meeting of the European Association of Young Economists (EAYE) King's College London, London	<i>Jan. 2025</i>
Conference Co-organizer and Scientific Committee Member 1st Tor Vergata Ph.D. Conference in Economics University of Rome Tor Vergata, Rome	<i>Sept. 2024</i>

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant

Oct. 2023

Paper: *A further look at the gender gap in Italian academic careers*

Authors: Marianna Brunetti, Annalisa Fabretti, Mariangela Zoli

Research Assistant

July 2022

Paper: *Teaching an old dog a new trick: Reserve price and unverifiable quality in repeated procurement*

Authors: Gian Luigi Albano, Berardino Cesi, Alberto Iozzi

SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES PRESENTATIONS

2026 (including scheduled)

- Annual Conference of the International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE).
- European Association of Young Economists Annual Meeting (EAYE).
- Frontiers of Causal Inference and Machine Learning (CIML, invited presentation).
- VIVE – Danish Center for Social Science Research (invited presentation).

2025

- 16th International Health Economics Association World Congress (IHEA).
- Annual Conference of the International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE).
- 38th Annual Conference of the European Society for Population Economics (ESPE).
- 11th Italian Congress of Econometrics and Empirical Economics (ICEEE).

2024

- CSQIEP Virtual Seminar.
- Rome Conference on Econometrics: Frontiers in Causal Inference.
- 3rd Rome Ph.D. in Economics and Finance Conference.
- 29th International Panel Data Conference (IPDC).
- Annual Conference of the International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE Thessaloniki).
- Annual Conference of the International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE Xiamen).
- Annual Conference of the Scottish Economic Society (SES).

2023

- 2nd Rome Ph.D. in Economics and Finance Conference.
- 11th SIde Workshop for Ph.D. students in Econometrics and Empirical Economics (WEEE).
- 10th Italian Congress of Econometrics and Empirical Economics (ICEEE).

2022

- 1st Rome Ph.D. in Economics and Finance Conference.
- 10th SIde Workshop for Ph.D. students in Econometrics and Empirical Economics (WEEE).

OTHER RELEVANT EXPERIENCES

Econometric Games–Team Captain

Apr. 2023

Selected to lead the University of Rome Tor Vergata team

University of Amsterdam, Amsterdam

Summer School in Causal Machine Learning

Oct. 2022

Lecturer: Michael Lechner

University of St. Gallen, St. Gallen

Summer School in Theoretical Aspects of Machine Learning

June 2022

Lecturer: Petyo Bonev

University of St. Gallen, St. Gallen

Summer School in Econometrics of Big Data

Lecturers: Christian Hansen, Martin Spindler
University of St. Gallen, St. Gallen

June 2022

Econometric Games–Team Captain

Selected to lead the University of Rome Tor Vergata team
University of Amsterdam, Amsterdam

Apr. 2022

Summer School in Semiparametric Learning

Lecturer: Yanyuan Ma
University of Trento, Trento

July 2021

Summer School in Microeconometrics and Machine Learning for Policy Evaluation

Lecturers: David Margolis, Philipp Ketz, Margherita Comola
Paris School of Economics, Paris

June 2021

Econometric Games–Team Member

Selected as a member of the University of Rome Tor Vergata team
University of Amsterdam, Amsterdam

Apr. 2021

REFERENCES

Franco Peracchi

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franco.peracchi@uniroma2.it

Seetha Menon

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Michael C. Knaus

University of Tübingen
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Giovanni Mellace

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giome@sam.sdu.dk